



# AI CRISIS COMMS BOOTCAMP RECAP

APRIL 10-11, 2025



# CRISIS COMMS BOOTCAMP (AI)

## OVERVIEW

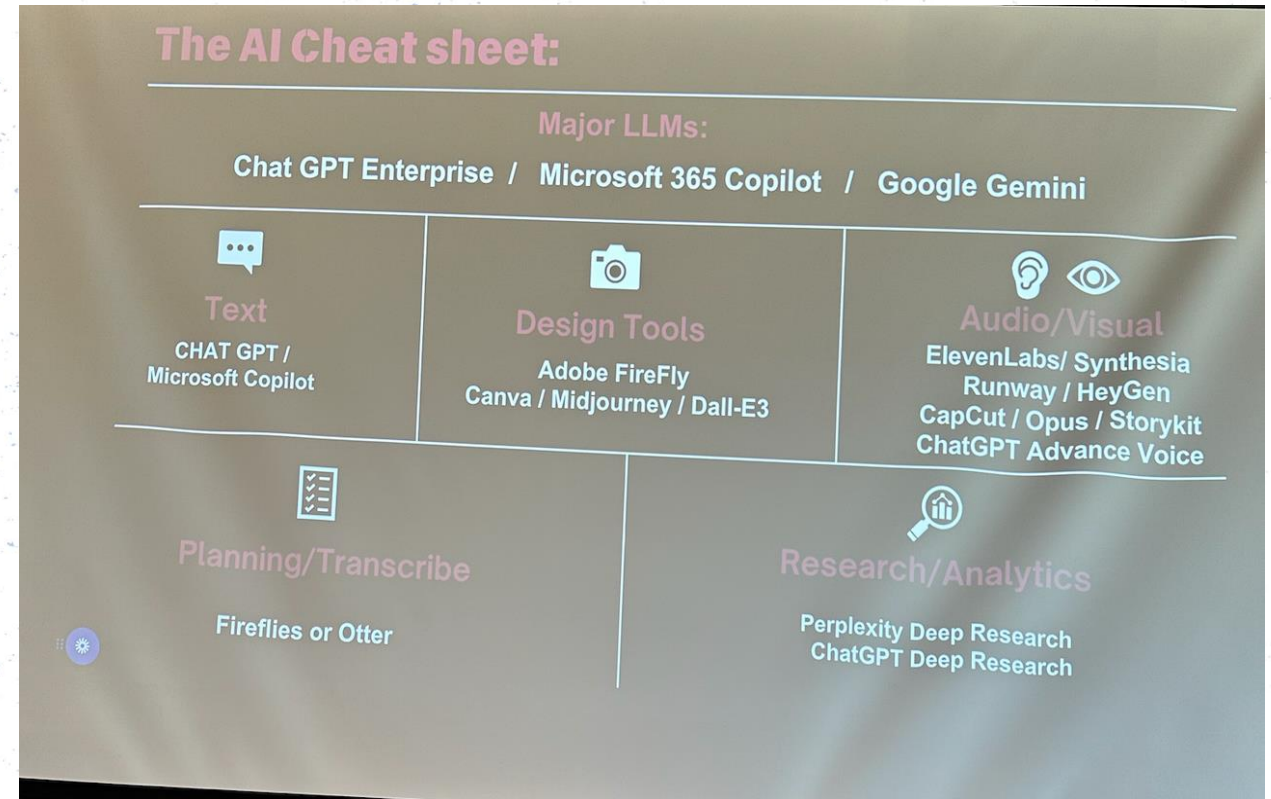
- AI tools and trends
- Reputational threats
- Overall takeaways/ideas



# AI TOOLS

## AI CRISIS COMMS BOOTCAMP

- AI tools are being used to:
  - Detect synthetic content
  - Monitor social
  - Help develop strategy, templates and content
  - Deploy deepfakes, inauthentic content
    - Source of artificial crises
  - Rapidly spread misinformation
    - Amplification during real crises
- 30% of companies' crisis communications will be AI-generated by the end of 2025



# AI TOOLS

## AI CRISIS COMMS BOOTCAMP

- We used LLMs (like ChatGPT paid) to...
  - Generate a UK style guide
  - Generate content in our voice
  - Conduct deep research on a topic
  - Train a GPT to respond to a crisis scenario
- We also used AI avatars to train a spokesperson
  - Yoodli— role-playing
- Other tools:
  - Heygen (real-time video translation)
  - Sigwatch
    - Monitor movements and pressure groups



# CRISIS RESPONSE

This is our scenario:

We are in a (hypothetical) crisis. The situation is that a high school student at Jones College Prep posted a photo of themselves on the way to school with a loaded 9 mm gun. They are on the school bus with other students, about to arrive at school.

Understood. This is a critical incident that requires immediate, clear, and coordinated communication to protect lives, maintain trust, and manage public concern.

Let's begin crisis response using the **STOP framework**.

## S – Strategy

### Crisis Overview

- **Known:** A high school student at Jones College Prep posted an image with a loaded 9mm handgun while en route to school on a bus. Other students are on board. Local law enforcement has been alerted and is responding.
- **Unknown:** The student's current intent; whether others are involved; if any threats were made beyond the photo.
- **Clearance Status:** Rapid pre-clearance required for initial holding lines; expedite approvals through chain of command or emergency bypass process.

### Objectives

- **Primary:** Ensure student and staff safety.
- **Secondary:** Minimize panic, maintain trust with families, coordinate with law enforcement, and ensure accurate information flow.
- **Success Measures:** Safe outcome, minimal misinformation, strong parent/staff confidence in response.

### Audiences & Impacts

- **Primary:** Students, parents, faculty, law enforcement.
- **Secondary:** Media, school district leadership, wider public.
- **Vulnerable Groups:** Students with trauma triggers, non-English speaking families, staff on-site.

### Message Principles

- Empathy first: acknowledge fear and concern.
- Transparency: share known facts, clarify unknowns.
- Reassurance: outline active safety measures.
- Timely updates: commit to frequent, consistent communication.

## T – Tactics

### First Hour Actions (we're in this window)

- Verify incident details with law enforcement and school leadership.

Message





# UK STYLE GUIDE

New partnership for Advancing Kentucky... PDF

Can you add this one to the three I previously gave you, and re-do your guide/analysis?

Here is your updated and refined **voice and style guide**, incorporating the latest document you provided, along with the previous three:

## Refined Voice and Style Analysis

### Overall Voice and Tone

Your content maintains a professional, authoritative yet approachable voice that underscores empathy, clarity, and transparency. Messages consistently convey a reassuring and proactive stance, with a clear emphasis on community, collaboration, shared responsibility, and institutional mission.

Your communication positions the university as a dedicated leader, focused on meaningful partnerships, transparency, and accountability—whether addressing community safety, collaborative educational initiatives, sensitive historical issues, or institutional achievements.

## Key Characteristics

### 1. Professional and Authoritative

- You confidently position the university as a trusted, credible leader ("UK is committed," "we announced a new partnership," "we will invest the necessary resources") A MESSAGE TO OUR COMMUNITY REGARDING SAFETY | UKNOW.PDF NEW PARTNERSHIP FOR ADVANCING KENTUCKY TOGETHER NETWORK.PDF
- Communications highlight institutional leadership and expertise ("the state's flagship, land-grant institution," "catalyst for breakthroughs and a force for healing") A MESSAGE TO OUR COMMUNITY REGARDING SAFETY | UKNOW.PDF NEW PARTNERSHIP FOR ADVANCING KENTUCKY TOGETHER NETWORK.PDF

### 2. Empathetic and Community-Oriented

- Frequent expressions of care for individuals and communities ("Your safety is always our top priority," "Respect the community," "Safety is a shared responsibility") A MESSAGE TO OUR COMMUNITY REGARDING SAFETY | UKNOW.PDF CELEBRATE LIKE A CHAMPION: NCAA TOURNAMENT SAFETY REMINDERS | UKNOW.PDF
- Recognize and address community concerns with sensitivity and accountability ("We recognize the pain caused by past practices") NAGPRA RELEASE.DOCK

### 3. Transparent and Accountable

- A clear commitment to transparency, especially when handling sensitive or complex issues like NAGPRA repatriation ("transparent, respectful, and legal manner," "transparency, dignity, and respect") NAGPRA RELEASE.DOCK
- Consistently acknowledge past challenges, outline steps taken, and discuss ongoing improvements or next steps clearly and openly A MESSAGE TO OUR COMMUNITY REGARDING SAFETY | UKNOW.PDF NAGPRA RELEASE.DOCK

### 4. Action-Oriented and Direct

- Clear instructions and actionable steps provided directly to the community, emphasizing individual and collective responsibilities ("If you see something suspicious, report it," "Plan your ride ahead of time") A MESSAGE TO OUR COMMUNITY REGARDING SAFETY | UKNOW.PDF CELEBRATE LIKE A CHAMPION: NCAA TOURNAMENT SAFETY REMINDERS | UKNOW.PDF
- Regularly include practical, easy-to-follow guidance to empower read ↓

Message ChatGPT

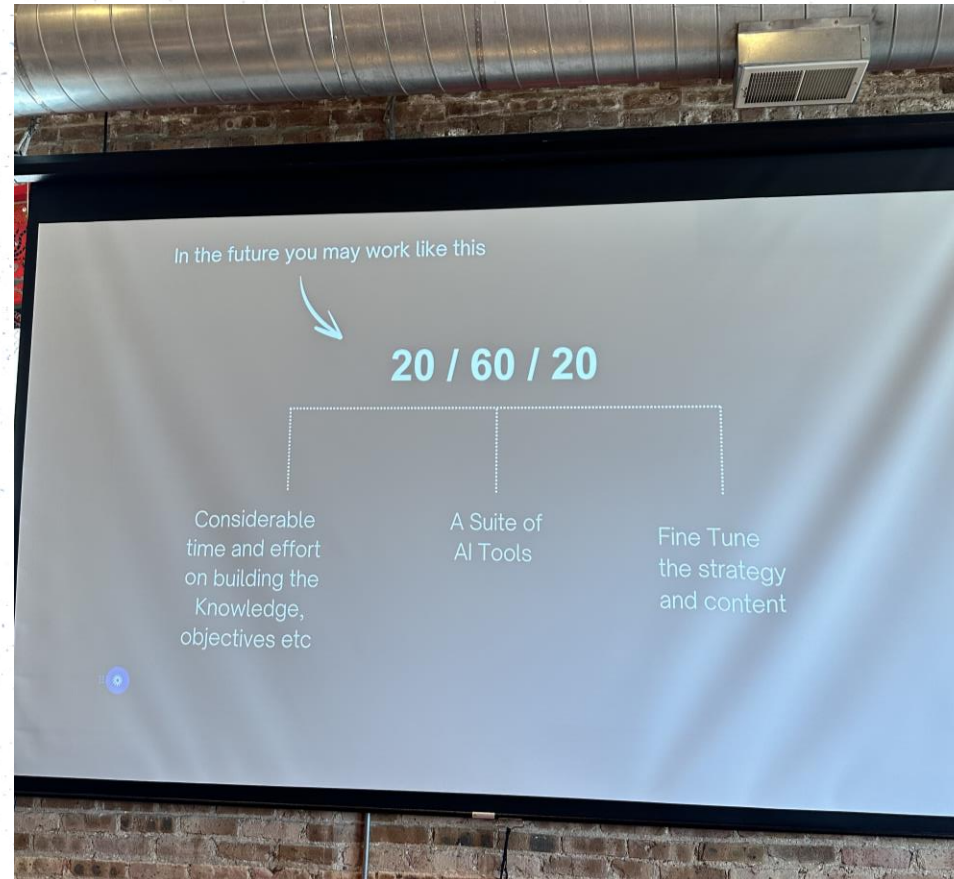
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# AI TOOLS

## AI CRISIS COMMS BOOTCAMP

### Human intervention + automation





# REPUTATIONAL THREATS

## AI CRISIS COMMS BOOTCAMP

- AI-generated disinformation is a top reputational concern
  - Disinformation: shared with **malicious intent**, usually financial
  - Executive impersonation
  - Synthetic evidence creation
  - Crisis amplification
- AI-generated crises reach peak online distribution in 37 minutes
  - Responses within 30 minutes contains spread by 67%
  - Coordinated cross-platform responses reduce spread more than single channel
  - It took companies 3-5x longer to recover from an AI-generated/amplified crisis

# REPUTATIONAL THREATS

## AI CRISIS COMMS BOOTCAMP

- Neutralizing:

### Speed and Accuracy: A Delicate Balance

|               |                             |                        |
|---------------|-----------------------------|------------------------|
| 10-15 minutes | Awareness, explicit warning | "We are aware of..."   |
| 30-60 minutes | Sequential verification     | "We are working to..." |
| 2 hours       | Technical explainers        | "Starting at..."       |
| evergreen     | Consistent messaging        |                        |

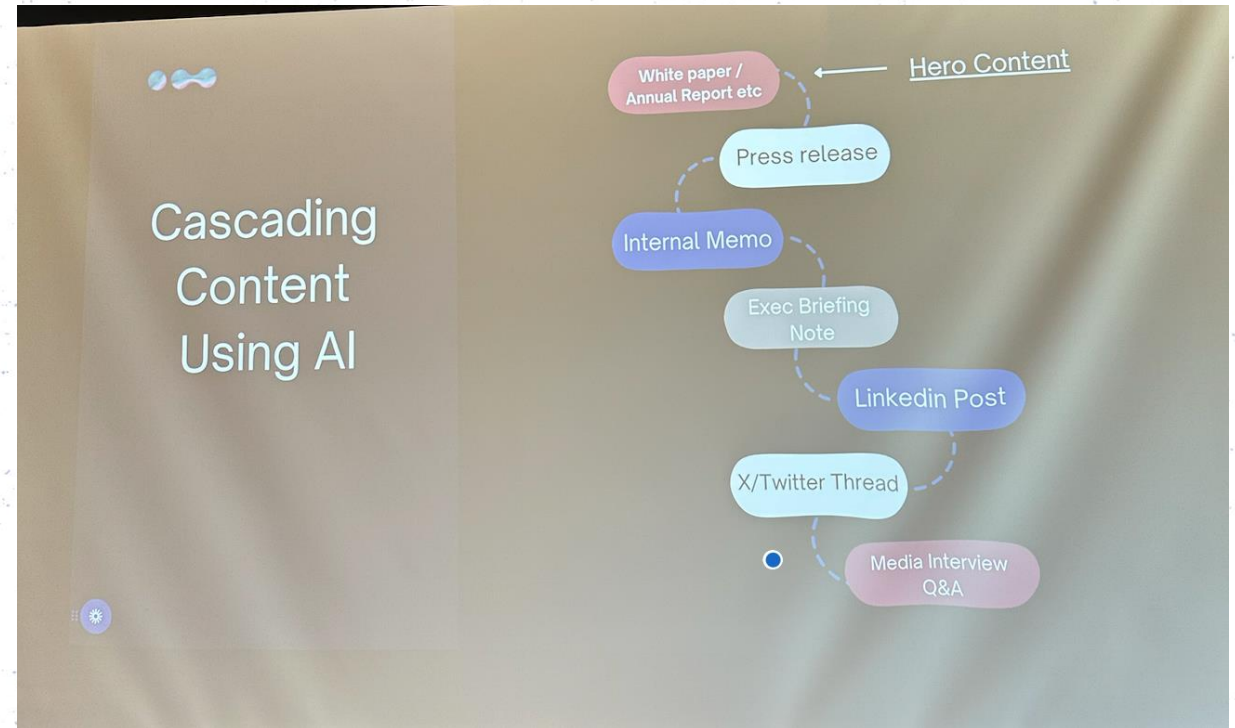
- When to ignore:

- When it hasn't reached real accounts – voices vs. noise

# IDEAS/NEXT STEPS

## AI CRISIS COMMS BOOTCAMP

- AI detection and response
  - Social monitoring + AI – Sprout?
  - Social platforms + deepfakes/AI accounts
  - ITS contacts
- Explore paid ChatGPT
  - Build library of prompts
  - Update crisis plan
  - Cascade content





# IDEAS/NEXT STEPS

## AI CRISIS COMMS BOOTCAMP



- General crisis comms response tips:
  - Focus on Rapid Response + Permacrisis
  - Take pictures of emergency/response to combat misinformation – knowledge replaces fear
  - Define don't defend – USA Gymnastics case study
  - Responsive not reactive
  - Protect and correct without amplifying misinformation – coordination faster than algorithm
  - Third party validators post-crisis